



AI Investment CHALLENGE

AI is revolutionizing investing—this challenge calls on you to design an AI solution that solves real investment problems or supercharges efficiency, insight, and impact.



Turning learning into leading. And elevate the investment industry

We believe the best minds can change the world.

For over 75 years, CFA Institute has supported investment professionals to excel and to lead a profession that works for the ultimate benefit of society.

We provide access to opportunities, set ethical benchmarks that protect investors, markets, and society, and turn complexity into clarity through our world-class research. And with a community of over 200,000 members, we provide a powerful resource for meaningful growth and collaboration.

**The AI Investment Challenge
calls on participants to design
AI solutions that solve real
investment problems or those that
supercharge efficiency, insight,
and impact.**

Set the Standard.

Learning | Research | Membership | Standards



Participants will advance through three stages, from concept development to final code submission and expert evaluation.

Stage 1: Concept Submission

Objective:

Present a clear and well-structured concept that uses AI to solve or improve an investment industry problem.



Team Structure:

Teams of 3–4 participants will submit a 2–4 page written concept outlining their proposed solution.

Each concept submission must include:

- 1 Problem Definition:** Describe the real-world investment challenge or inefficiency you're addressing and why it matters.
- 2 Solution Overview:** Explain how your AI-based approach works — conceptually or technically. Include the models, data sources, or workflow you intend to implement.
- 3 Planned Implementation:** Outline the technical stack, tools, and approach you will use to build and verify your solution in later stages.
- 4 Impact Assessment:** Highlight how your solution could improve performance, efficiency, or insight in the investment process.
- 5 Ethical Considerations:** Briefly discuss any data, model, or bias considerations and how you plan to handle them responsibly.

Outcome:

Judges will evaluate submissions on innovation, relevance, impact and feasibility. Top teams will be selected to advance to Stage 2.

Stage 2: Mentorship & Solution Development

Objective:

Build a verifiable, working AI solution based on the Stage 1 concept.

Process:

- Selected teams will be paired with a CFA Charterholder mentor to guide them through refining and implementing their solution.
- Teams are expected to produce functional code, not a conceptual demo or mock-up.

Deliverable Requirements:

Functional Code:

- Must be provided in a Jupyter Notebook or GitHub Repository with clear documentation

Technical Explanation (2-4 pages):

- 4-bullet executive summary
- Architectural design, workflow, and data sources
- Discussion of results and model interpretability
- AI usage disclosure

For Tools or Web Apps:

- The solution should be hosted via GitHub Pages (or an equivalent public deployment).
- The submission must include links to both the front-end and the underlying source code repository.

Outcome:

Submissions will be evaluated on results, functionality, and communication. Top teams will be selected to advance to Stage 3.

No slide decks, concept demos, or mock tools will be accepted at this stage — Only testable code (partially completed code will still be accepted for advancement if there is a clear path to completion)



Stage 3: Final Presentation & Judging

Objective:

Present the working solution to a panel of industry experts.

Format:

- The top 5 teams will present their solutions live to a panel of judges.
- 10-minute presentation followed by 5-minute Q&A with judges.
- Presentations should focus on the real-world investment application, technical robustness, and ethical aspects of the project.

Judging Criteria:

Category	Description	Weight
Innovation	Originality and creativity of the idea	10%
Relevance	Relevance and practicality within the investment industry	10%
Impact	Demonstrated efficiency or insight improvement	10%
Responsible AI	Transparency, ethics, and bias awareness	20%
Delivery Execution	Clarity, persuasiveness, teamwork, and overall communication quality in presenting the solution	50%

Outcome:

Winning teams will be recognized by CFA Institute and CFA Society of UK, with cash prizes, scholarships, and opportunities to showcase their work to the investment community.

Prizes & Benefits

Cash Prizes:

- 1st Place: £2,000
- 2nd Place: £1,200
- 3rd Place: £800

Prize money will be distributed equally along team members and paid directly to individuals. Winners are responsible for any applicable taxes on prize earnings.

In addition, all winning team members will receive a scholarship to take the CFA Program Level I exam.

Showcase Opportunity:

Winning solutions will have the opportunity to be featured on the CFA Institute Research and Policy Center's RPC Labs— an open-source initiative that brings together investment professionals and data scientists to advance the industry through collaborative technical research and innovation.



Challenge Scope

Participants may focus on any domain within the investment value chain, including but not limited to:

- **Research and analysis** – using AI to interpret financial statements, earnings calls, or macro data
- **Portfolio management** – optimization, attribution, or risk monitoring
- **Sustainability and ESG** – detecting greenwashing, classifying ESG risks, or assessing impact
- **Trading and execution** – signal generation, order optimization, or liquidity analysis
- **Client reporting and communication** – summarizing performance or explaining portfolio decisions
- **Operational efficiency** – automating repetitive processes or improving data integration

Solutions may use any AI technique (generative, agentic, or machine learning) and any publicly available dataset.

The emphasis is on real-world impact, technical rigor, and responsible use of AI.

Example Directions

(Non-Prescriptive)

- Building an agent that automates part of an analyst's workflow
- Using AI for improved macroeconomic nowcasting
- Designing an LLM-based portfolio explainer for clients
- Applying ML to detect anomalies in ESG or financial disclosures

Outcome

Participants should aim to demonstrate how AI can transform investment practice — by delivering verifiable, working solutions that make the investment process more efficient, insightful, and aligned with responsible innovation.



Join now and shape the future of investment with AI